PRESS KIT · NOVEMBER 2026

Zackary Mark, student advocate

IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Zackary Mark is a student at Sun Prairie West High School in Sun Prairie, Wisconsin. Since January 2026 he has run two independent, student-led projects: **SPASD Student Voice**, which brings student input to Sun Prairie Area School District leaders, and **Sun Prairie ALPR**, a plain-language community report on the police department's license plate reader cameras. His work has led to written district commitments on student newsletters and LGBTQIA+ protections, student seats in principal hiring, a restarted Student Senate, a student-shaped weighted grades plan, and written answers from the police chief on how plate reader data is kept and audited.

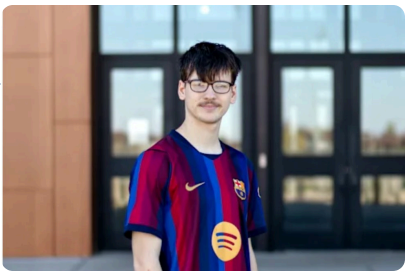
FACT SHEET

Projects	SPASD Student Voice (spasdstudentvoice.netlify.app, @spasdstudentvoice, studentvoicesp@gmail.com); Sun Prairie ALPR (sunprairiealpr.netlify.app, @sunprairiealpr, sunprairiealpr@gmail.com)
Started	January 2026, with an email to the Board of Education about student safety and trust
Funding	None. Independent and unaffiliated with the district, the city or the police department
Surveys	Act 95 student survey: 903 students, 78% of those choosing a ranking option picked a weighted GPA. District caregiver survey (Oct 2026): 531 responses, 70% support weighted grades
Student council	Proposed a District-Wide Student Council Oct 29; Superintendent Dr. Antoine Reed: "I love this idea." Patrick Marsh Middle School signed on Nov 5
Plate readers	The city is weighing a switch from Flock to Axon: 9 cameras, $235,388.97 over 10 years in a draft estimate. The Chief committed in writing to a 14-day retention trial, no livestreaming and monthly audits. City budget vote Nov 17
The record	A public archive of every email, meeting and document, with student names removed and corrections logged

COVERAGE

"Helping Others Find Their Voice: Zackary Mark's Commitment to Student Advocacy," Sun Prairie Area School District, November 3, 2026 (sunprairieschools.org).

QUOTES (FROM THE DISTRICT'S NOV 3 FEATURE)



> "When I first started this, I didn't have that confidence. I've grown that, but you have to be able to send an email. Like, that's basic stuff, and then you gradually go from there."

> "The district said this, that they're gonna do this. Now here's the evidence that they did this."

BIO

Zackary Mark is a student at Sun Prairie West High School. His advocacy started in January 2026 with an email to the Board of Education about student safety and trust, and grew into the Act 95 and weighted grades work group, a student voice survey and public reports, meetings with district leaders about the budget, mental health and student voice, and a community report on Sun Prairie's license plate reader cameras. He isn't part of a formal organization; he works on his own and alongside other students because he believes young people should be able to understand the decisions that affect them and question the people who make them. He speaks English and Spanish and plans to become a social studies teacher.

STORY IDEAS

- A student-designed "You said, we did" system for tracking whether district promises are kept.
- How a student's questions put plate reader retention and audit limits in writing before a city budget vote.
- Building a student council across every middle and high school, one principal at a time.

CONTACT

Zackary Mark · (608) 940-7356
Student Voice: studentvoicesp@gmail.com · Plate readers: sunprairiealpr@gmail.com
Instagram @spasdstudentvoice and @sunprairiealpr · Photo: Sun Prairie Area School District

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